

Step 1 - Admitted we were **powerless over alcohol**, that our lives had become **unmanageable**

Powerless over alcohol/chemicals is the inability to consistently control alcohol/chemical use. Write any example of how each of the following symptoms has shown up in your life. Include your emotional response to each example, such as pain, anger, shame, guilt, fear

- 1) **PROGRESSION**: This may mean using alcohol more often or for longer periods of time, increasing or losing tolerance, for it
- 2) **LOSS OF CONTROL**: This may mean trying to cut down on your use, not using and then using as much or more often than before, not drinking for days, weeks or months
- 3) **DESTRUCTIVE BEHAVIOR**: Examples may include physical or verbal abuse, destruction of property, suicide attempts, self-destructive behaviors
- 4) **PREOCCUPATION**: May mean looking forward to using alcohol, setting up situations to use, having a good supply on hand at all times
- 5) **PROTECTION**: These behaviors may include hiding bottles, sneaking alcohol, using breath sprays to cover up, switching liquor stores
- 6) **JUSTIFYING ALCOHOL USE**: Examples may include blaming people or situations for my alcoholism, making excuses, and/or rationalizing use